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PREMIUM NOTES

RPSC — Indian History Notes

RPSC Test Series — StuDy

High-yield facts, formulas and trap-radar — made for the real exam hall.

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RPSC — Indian History Notes

Ancient India Essentials

- Indus Valley: Harappa (Ravi), Mohenjo-daro (Indus — Great Bath, Great Granary), Lothal (dockyard, Gujarat), Dholavira (water reservoirs, Kutch), Kalibangan (ploughed field). No temples/horse (debated) — seals, unicorn most common animal.
- Vedas: Rigveda (oldest, 1028 hymns, Gayatri Mantra — dedicated to Savitri); Sama (music), Yajur (rituals), Atharva (charms/medicine). Upanishads = Vedanta.
- Mahavira (24th Tirthankara; Parshvanatha was 23rd) — Jain councils: Pataliputra & Vallabhi. Buddha: born Lumbini, enlightenment Bodh Gaya, first sermon Sarnath (Dharmachakra), death Kushinagar; councils at Rajgriha, Vaishali, Pataliputra, Kundalvana.
- Mauryas: Chandragupta (founder, Sandrocottus), Bindusara, Ashoka (Kalinga 261 BCE; edicts in Brahmi, deciphered by James Prinsep 1837). Arthashastra — Kautilya. Indica — Megasthenes.
- Guptas (Golden Age): Chandragupta I (founder of era 319-20 CE), Samudragupta (Napoleon of India — V.A. Smith; Allahabad Prashasti by Harisena), Chandragupta II Vikramaditya (Fa-Hien visited), Kumaragupta (Nalanda). Aryabhata, Kalidasa, Sushruta (surgery), Charaka (medicine).
- Harsha (606–647): Kannauj; Hiuen Tsang visited; wrote Ratnavali, Nagananda, Priyadarshika; Banabhatta wrote Harshacharita. Chalukyas (Aihole inscription — Ravikirti, Pulakesin II defeated Harsha on Narmada), Pallavas (Mahabalipuram), Cholas (Rajaraja I, Rajendra I — naval expeditions; local self-government — Uttaramerur inscriptions).

Medieval India Essentials

- Delhi Sultanate order: Slave (Qutbuddin Aibak — Qutub Minar begun; Iltutmish — real consolidator, iqta, tanka/jital) → Khilji (Alauddin — market control, Dagh & Chehra) → Tughlaq (Muhammad bin Tughlaq — token currency, capital shift; Firoz — welfare) → Sayyid → Lodi (Ibrahim, fell 1526).
- Vijayanagara (1336, Harihara & Bukka): Krishnadeva Raya (1509–29) — Amuktamalyada; Hampi; Battle of Talikota 1565.
- Mughals: Babur (1526) → Humayun → Akbar (1556–1605: mansabdari, zabt, Sulh-i-kul, Ibadat Khana, Din-i-Ilahi 1582, Fatehpur Sikri) → Jahangir (painting peak, Chain of Justice) → Shah Jahan (Taj Mahal, Red Fort, Peacock Throne) → Aurangzeb (1649–1707 reign 1658–1707: largest extent, jizya reimposed 1679).
- Bhakti & Sufi: Kabir, Guru Nanak (1469), Mirabai, Chaitanya, Tulsidas (Ramcharitmanas), Surdas; Nizamuddin Auliya (Chishti), Khwaja Moinuddin (Ajmer).
- Marathas: Shivaji (born 1630, Shivneri; coronation 1674 Raigad; Ashtapradhan; guerilla warfare); Peshwa era — Bajirao I (fastest expansion), Balaji Bajirao; Third Panipat 1761 vs Ahmad Shah Abdali.

Modern India — Freedom Struggle

- Revolt 1857: centres — Delhi (Bahadur Shah II), Kanpur (Nana Saheb/Tantia Tope), Lucknow (Begum Hazrat Mahal), Jhansi (Rani Lakshmibai), Bihar (Kunwar Singh), Bareilly (Khan Bahadur). Governor-General: Canning.
- INC sessions to know: 1885 Bombay (W.C. Bonnerjee), 1907 Surat (split), 1916 Lucknow (reunion + League pact), 1920 Nagpur (NCM adopted), 1929 Lahore (Purna Swaraj — Nehru), 1931 Karachi (Fundamental Rights — Patel).

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- Gandhian movements: Champaran 1917 (indigo), Kheda 1918, Ahmedabad Mill 1918; Non-Cooperation 1920–22; Civil Disobedience 1930 (Dandi, 12 Mar–6 Apr 1930, 78 followers, 240 miles); Quit India 8 Aug 1942 ('Do or Die').
- Revolutionaries: Kakori 1925 (HRA), HSRA 1928, Bhagat Singh–Rajguru–Sukhdev (Lahore Conspiracy; hanged 23 Mar 1931), Chittagong Armoury Raid 1930 (Surya Sen), INA (Rash Behari Bose → Subhas Chandra Bose; 'Jai Hind', 'Delhi Chalo').
- Acts: 1909 Morley–Minto (separate electorates), 1919 Montagu–Chelmsford (dyarchy), 1935 GOI Act (provincial autonomy, federation proposed), 1947 Independence Act (Mountbatten Plan 3 June).

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